



Re-Engineered Discharge (RED) Toolkit

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A variety of forces are pushing hospitals to improve their discharge processes to reduce readmissions. Researchers at the Boston University Medical Center (BUMC) developed and tested the Re-Engineered Discharge (RED). Research showed that the RED was effective at reducing readmissions and posthospital emergency department (ED) visits. The Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality contracted with BUMC to develop this toolkit to assist hospitals, particularly those that serve diverse populations, to replicate the RED.

Select for the [Taking Care of Myself: A Guide for When I Leave the Hospital \(https://www.ahrq.gov/patients-consumers/diagnosis-treatment/hospitals-clinics/goinghome/index.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/patients-consumers/diagnosis-treatment/hospitals-clinics/goinghome/index.html), a booklet for patients based on the RED Toolkit.

Related Content

- [Case Study: Pennsylvania Psychiatric Institute Slashes Readmission Rates with AHRQ-based Discharge Program \(https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201706.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201706.html)
- [Case Study: Penn Medicine Chester County Hospital Implements AHRQ Toolkit to Reduce Readmissions \(https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201506.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201506.html)
- [Case Study: AHRQ's RED Toolkit Helps Lower Readmissions in Dignity Health Hospitals \(https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201522.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201522.html)
- [Case Study: Memorial Hospital Uses AHRQ Resources to Cut Readmissions, Promote Patient Self-Management \(https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201507.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201507.html)
- [Case Study: AHRQ's RED Toolkit Inspires Improved Patient Discharge at Nacogdoches Memorial Hospital \(https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201501.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201501.html)
- [Case Study: AHRQ's RED Toolkit Leads to Lower Readmissions, Better Care Transitions in Two Texas Hospitals \(https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201420.html\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/news/newsroom/case-studies/201420.html)
- Read about lessons learned from implementing RED in ten hospitals across the country in, "[How Hospitals Reengineer Their Discharge Processes to Reduce Readmissions \(http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/26042743\)](http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/26042743)." *J Healthcare Qual* 2016 Mar-Apr;38(2):116-26. (Winner of the 2016 JHQ Impact Article of the Year)
- Learn how a hospital that participated in AHRQ's [RED Training Program \(http://archive.ahrq.gov/professionals/systems/hospital/red/index.html\)](http://archive.ahrq.gov/professionals/systems/hospital/red/index.html) reduced readmissions by 32% in, "[Implementation of the Re-Engineered Discharge \(RED\) toolkit to decrease all-cause readmission rates at a rural community hospital \(http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/24978166\)](http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/24978166)."
- Learn about how five California hospitals adapted and implemented RED and the subsequent impact on RED program sustainability in "[Implementation and adaptation of the Re-Engineered Discharge \(RED\) in five California hospitals: a qualitative research study \(https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC5397802/\)](https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC5397802/)."

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[New and Improved RED Toolkit \(https://www.ahrq.gov/patient-safety/settings/hospital/red/toolkit/redtool1.html#New\)](https://www.ahrq.gov/patient-safety/settings/hospital/red/toolkit/redtool1.html#New)

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Tool 7: Understanding and Enhancing the Role of Family Caregivers in the Re-Engineered Discharge

To augment the Re-Engineered Discharge Toolkit, Carol Levine and Jennifer Rutberg of United Hospital Fund and Brian Jack and Ramon Cancino of Boston University School of Medicine have developed [Tool 7: Understanding and Enhancing the Role of Family Caregivers in the Re-Engineered Discharge \(http://www.bu.edu/fammed/projectred/Project%20RED%20Revised%20Toolkit%209-2012/REDTool7FamilyCaregiversUnitedHospital%20Fund.pdf\)](http://www.bu.edu/fammed/projectred/Project%20RED%20Revised%20Toolkit%209-2012/REDTool7FamilyCaregiversUnitedHospital%20Fund.pdf)  (PDF, 428 KB).

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